

Indian House Husband .com

EMBRACING • SHARING • INSPIRING

QUARTERLY JOURNAL

ISSUE 01 · JUNE – SEPTEMBER 2026

Same Home. New Perspective.

REAL STORIES · EVERYDAY LIFE · DIFFERENT LENS · SAME LOVE

QUARTERLY JOURNAL · ISSUE 01

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FROM THE EDITOR

A *small beginning*

When I wrote the first post in June, I didn't know it would turn into sixteen weeks.

Indian House Husband began as a way to put into words what daily domestic life looks like from where I sit: the quiet work, the small joys, and the questions I kept being asked. Over these weeks the words moved from a Facebook page to Medium and Substack, then to a website of their own and, in October, to Instagram.

This journal holds that first stretch, June to September, in one place. It is not everything I wrote. It is the sentence that started it, a week-by-week map, six pieces I would want you to read first, a page of comics, and what I think I have learned. Each story is a short excerpt in my own words, and the full piece is one tap away.

Thank you for reading someone else's ordinary life. If any of it sounds like yours, that was always the point of writing it down.

With gratitude,
Indian House Husband

THE BEGINNING

Week 1: *Main karta kya hoon?*

"I am a house husband."

WEEK ONE · JUNE 12, 2026

It began with a simple question at my wife's office party: "A*ajkal kya kar rahe ho*?" What are you up to these days?

> "I am a house husband." I said this out loud at my wife's office party. And for the first time, it didn't feel strange. To be honest, this wasn't something I consciously chose. No Indian man really grows up planning to become a "house husband." …

That one line, said out loud without hesitation, opened a new chapter. This journal is part of that journey.

Read the full story · Week 1

OUR JOURNEY SO FAR

From a single post to a growing community

- 12 JUNE 2026

  Week One. The first post goes out, and from here every week is shared on Facebook, Medium and Substack together.

- WEEK AFTER WEEK

  Daily posts on Facebook, one combined essay each on Medium (English) and Substack (Roman Hinglish). Home, family, money, school, the hometown.

- A HOME OF ITS OWN

  indianhousehusband.com, the one place that is only ours. Each essay there points back out to the other platforms.

- 4 OCTOBER 2026

  Instagram, @_indianhousehusband. One short video every Saturday, from the same stories in smaller bites.

- COMING

  YouTube: videos of two to fifteen minutes, still in development.

Facebook

Line-by-line posts in a mix of Hindi and English. They open with the day and end with a question, so the conversation happens in the comments.

Instagram

Short videos. The same stories in smaller bites, reaching people who have never seen the page.

SIXTEEN WEEKS AT A GLANCE

June to September, week by week

WEEK 1 · 12 JUNE

I Said “I Am a House Husband” Out Loud for the First Time

Said “I am a house husband” out loud at his wife’s office party, and for the first time it didn’t feel strange.

On Facebook: “Main karta kya hoon?”

Also on Medium · Substack

WEEK 2 · 19 JUNE

“What will people say?” Was the Hardest Question We Faced

Why one of us stepping back came before the question of what people would say, and why family was the hardest audience.

On Facebook: Log kya kahenge?

Also on Medium · Substack

WEEK 3 · 26 JUNE

Is Housework Really “Work”?

Cooking three meals a day was only the visible part. Five days showed how much work goes unnoticed because it “just happens”.

On Facebook: Ghar ka kaam “kaam” hai kya?

Also on Medium · Substack

WEEK 4 · 3 JULY

The Hardest Part Wasn’t Leaving My Job. It Was Losing My Identity.

Not the housework and not the money: the hardest part of leaving the job was losing an identity.

On Facebook: Kahin main khud ko toh nahi kho raha?

Also on Medium · Substack

WEEK 5 · 10 JULY

When Our Roles Reversed, So Did My Understanding of Marriage

Thinking about mothers who spent their lives as homemakers, and how reversing roles changed his understanding of marriage.

On Facebook: जब roles reverse हुए...

Also on Medium · Substack

WEEK 6 · 17 JULY

Can Men Care for Children? My Mother Thought So.

On caregiving as a matter of opportunity, practice and responsibility rather than gender.

On Facebook: क्या बच्चे संभालना सिर्फ माँ की ज़िम्मेदारी है?

Also on Medium · Substack

WEEK 7 · 24 JULY

When My Salary Disappeared, So Did Some People's Respect

The second salary was funding the lifestyle, not the bills, and the surprise of how income can change the way people see you.

On Facebook: क्या इंसान की value उसकी salary से होती है?

Also on Medium · Substack

WEEK 8 · 31 JULY

The Most Valuable Thing I Gained After Leaving My Job Wasn't Freedom. It Was Time.

Everyone asked how the family would manage on one income. Few asked what the time would be worth.

On Facebook: शायद ज़िंदगी का सबसे बड़ा luxury... Time ही है।

Also on Medium · Substack

SIXTEEN WEEKS AT A GLANCE, CONTINUED

WEEK 9 · 7 AUGUST

When Society Mistakes Caregiving for Dependence

"He's living off his wife's income": how deeply a man's worth is tied to his salary.

On Facebook: लोग समझते क्या हैं ?

Also on Medium · Substack

WEEK 10 · 14 AUGUST

The Decision I Never Stopped Questioning—Until I Looked Back

A break he thought was temporary, the plans that kept getting interrupted, and what looking back made clear.

On Facebook: Retrospection

Also on Medium · Substack

WEEK 11 · 21 AUGUST

The Longest Examination Is Parenthood

A preschool hunt for a three-year-old, set against the NEET paper-leak debate, and what a fair system owes children.

On Facebook: School Hunting

Also on Medium · Substack

WEEK 12 · 28 AUGUST

From Year-Long Planning to Weekly Meal Plans: How the Way We Run Our Homes Has Changed

From a long-range plan to a Monday-to-Friday meal plan, and the energy it frees up for everything else.

On Facebook: Meal Planning

Also on Medium · Substack

WEEK 13 · 4 SEPTEMBER

On Comfort, Discipline, and the Quiet Curriculum of a Home

Comfort without carelessness, and the home as a small school whose teacher is whoever runs it.

On Facebook: Technology – Boon or Bane

Also on Medium · Substack

WEEK 14 · 11 SEPTEMBER

The Two Habits That Made Leaving My Job — and a Medical Emergency — Less Frightening

Two money habits, adjusting and never letting savings slip, that were in place long before they were needed.

On Facebook: बच्चों को पैसे कमाना ही नहीं, संभालना भी सिखाना चाहिए ।

Also on Medium · Substack

WEEK 15 · 18 SEPTEMBER

What It's Really Like to Move Back to a Small Town After the Big City

A move back to the hometown when his father's health took a turn, and what it meant for a wife raised in apartment culture.

On Facebook: घर वापस आना मेरे लिए आसान था... उसके लिए नहीं ।

Also on Medium · Substack

WEEK 16 · 25 SEPTEMBER

The Cast of Characters Every Hometown Seems to Have

A front-row seat to the different kinds of households in a hometown, and a reminder that every story has two sides.

On Facebook: Hometown में हर तरह के पति मिल जाएंगे...

Also on Medium · Substack

SELECTED STORIES

Moments that stayed with us

Excerpts in my own words. The full story is one tap away.

WEEK 2 · JUNE 19, 2026

“What will people say?” Was the Hardest Question We Faced

Not every decision needs approval to be right. Some decisions just need courage.

When we first started thinking about becoming parents, the biggest question wasn’t how we would raise a child. It was something much more familiar. “What will people say?” ...

Read the full story

WEEK 4 · JULY 3, 2026

The Hardest Part Wasn’t Leaving My Job. It Was Losing My Identity.

Because slowly, over time, you do build a new identity. It just takes longer than you expect.

If you’ve read my previous pieces, you might think I’m completely comfortable in my new role. The truth is — I wasn’t. At least not in the beginning. At first, it actually felt good. ...

Read the full story

WEEK 8 · JULY 31, 2026

The Most Valuable Thing I Gained After Leaving My Job Wasn't Freedom. It Was Time.

Maybe that's what real wealth looks like. Not having more things. But having more moments that matter.

When I left my job, almost every conversation revolved around one question: "How will your family manage on a single income?" It was a fair question. But very few people asked another one that, in hindsight, turned out to be far more important. ...

Read the full story

SELECTED STORIES, CONTINUED

WEEK 9 · AUGUST 7, 2026

When Society Mistakes Caregiving for Dependence

Perhaps equality isn't about doing identical jobs. Perhaps it's about giving equal dignity to different responsibilities.

One sentence follows many men who step away from paid work to care for their families. "He's living off his wife's income." The words may sound casual, but they reveal how deeply we associate a man's worth with his salary. …

Read the full story

WEEK 12 · AUGUST 28, 2026

From Year-Long Planning to Weekly Meal Plans: How the Way We Run Our Homes Has Changed

And maybe that's the actual point of all this planning — not a more efficient kitchen, but a little more energy left over for everything else.

Every day, before I even start cooking, there's a quieter task that eats up more energy than the cooking itself: deciding what to make. …

Read the full story

WEEK 14 · SEPTEMBER 11, 2026

The Two Habits That Made Leaving My Job — and a Medical Emergency — Less Frightening

The habits were in place long before we needed them.

Long before our daughter was born, my wife and I were both earning well, and more or less one salary alone was covering our daily expenses — the other went either toward things we wanted or straight into savings. …

Read the full story

All sixteen weeks, in full: Medium Substack indianhousehusband.com

COMIC STRIP

Same scenes. Different lens.

Three strips from Weeks 1, 3 and 7.



READERS' CORNER

Your words keep us going

This page is yours. These are three questions asked at the end of essays in this issue. If one of them sounds like your own house, we would love to hear your answer.

> *Have you ever felt people treated you differently because your income changed?*
> ASKED IN WEEK 7

> *Have you ever found your respect for your partner growing stronger after working through conflict together?*
> ASKED IN WEEK 5

> *Do we give them the chance?*
> ASKED IN WEEK 6

How to be in Issue 02

Answer on Facebook Instagram and add "print it". We will include a selection with first names only, and only with your permission.

To everyone who has liked, commented, shared, or read quietly and moved on: thank you. Your replies are the reason a diary became a journal.

KEY TAKEAWAYS

What stayed with us

> Work that “just happens” is still work.
>
> *Because they “just happen,” we assume they don’t require effort.* WEEK 3

> What he gained was time.
>
> *Not having more things. But having more moments that matter.* WEEK 8

> A second salary may fund the lifestyle, not the bills.
>
> *The second income wasn't paying our bills. It was funding our lifestyle.* WEEK 7

> Two habits did the quiet work.
>
> *The habits were in place long before we needed them.* WEEK 14

> Trust from a partner beats advice.
>
> *Sometimes the greatest gift your partner can give you isn't advice. It's trust.* WEEK 10

> Adaptability is its own kind of discipline.
>
> *Adaptability, I've come to think, is its own kind of discipline.* WEEK 13

WHAT'S NEXT

The road ahead

Instagram

One short video every Saturday.

The website

More essays added to indianhousehusband.com, so each story here links to its own full page.

YouTube

Videos of two to fifteen minutes, in development.

The comic strip

A recurring page, drawn from the stories in these issues.

Issue 02

The next quarterly journal, picking up where this one stops.

ABOUT

For eighteen years, I worked in software. Then, a little over four years ago, I left my job to run our home and raise our daughter, a decision that still needs explaining more often than I'd like.

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